

Here comes Pear Linux OS, inspired by Apple's iOS 7

Are you an open source lover who also happens to be impressed by the appearance of Apple's latest iOS 7? Well, there is a Linux operating system, especially for you. Dubbed Pear OS, it offers you the goodness of Ubuntu served up in an OS X and iOS 7-style user interface. The good news is that Pear OS 8 is now available for desktop and notebook computers. Besides, the developer of the OS, David Taveres, is hopeful of bringing it to tablets as well.

Pear OS 8 is clearly inspired by Apple's OS with the user interface, app launcher and even the colour scheme carrying a touch of iOS 7. The OS is available both in 32-bit and 64-bit flavours. The developer also says that there is a boost in performance as well as compatibility with a number of peripherals, which include MP3 players, cameras, and printers, as well as the Steam gaming platform. The OS also has a Pear Cloud utility to help you back up and sync contacts, documents, pictures, and other data over the Web.

Stable CyanogenMod 10.2 out for 70 devices

CyanogenMod has finally released a stable version of the CM 10.2 ROM, which is based on the Android 4.3 Jelly Bean operating system. The new ROM, called CM 10.2 M1, was released for 70 devices. This includes variants of the same smartphone.

The CM Team wrote in a blog post, "With all the Android 4.4 hype, we haven't forgotten about CM 10.2. Tonight the buildbots will focus their efforts on building and shipping out CyanogenMod 10.2 M1."

The work on the 10.2 ROM will continue, while the team will also start working on the Android 4.4 KitKat OS, side by side.

much is known about the specifications of the device though. Recently, there were reports that Microsoft had approached Samsung to bring out dual boot devices that would run on both the Android and Windows operating systems. Their plea seems to have been addressed by decision-makers at the OEM. The company is also reportedly going to launch a Windows-based smartphone pretty soon.

No exclusive games for Steam OS; Half-Life 3 open to all

Over the last so many decades, it's been fairly common for every new video game console to offer some exclusive games that cannot be played anywhere else. For instance, Nintendo has Mario, Sega had Sonic and Microsoft has Halo. However, things will be different with Valve Steam machines. Reportedly, the developer of Half-Life, Portal, Team Fortress, Left 4 Dead and Dota 2, says that it has plans to launch a line of Steam Machines in mid-2014, but it won't make games exclusive to the platform.

Valve's Doug Lombardi says that this is not the company's style. "It's against our philosophy to put a game in jail and say it only works on Steam Machines. It works best on Steam Machines, perhaps ... but to get to exclusives or anything else just wouldn't be our style," he said. Valve seems to be serious about promoting an open platform, but experts fear that it could limit SteamOS's early momentum.

Here are the features of LibreOffice 4.1.3

Writer is the word processor from LibreOffice that can be used for everything, ranging from writing a letter to making an entire book with the appropriate tables



of contents, illustrations, bibliographies and diagrams. It also allows auto-completion, auto-formatting and automatic spelling checks to make the task easy.

Use Calc to tame your numbers and analyse your data. It comes with charts and analysis tools to provide you with more transparency. A fully built-in help system makes it easier for you to enter your complex formulae. Draw allows you to construct diagrams and sketches from scratch. You can even create new pictures using box and line diagrams. Or easily create dynamic 3D illustrations using special effects.

With Base, the database front-end of the LibreOffice suite, it is possible to flawlessly mix into your current database structures. You can also construct powerful databases comprising forms, reports, views and queries based on imported and associated tables and queries from MySQL, PostgreSQL or Microsoft Access, and many other data sources. LibreOffice is equipped with a PDF file creator, which allows it to distribute documents.

Facebook launches open source academy to help students get jobs

Facebook has officially launched the Open Academy, which is aimed at helping computer science students prepare for jobs in the industry. Due to the social networking giant's tie-up with various computer science universities, special classes have been set up for which students can get college credits for various open source projects.

The Open Academy was tried out on a pilot basis at Stanford University last year. After its success,

